

HOW TO WORK ON VOICE LEADING

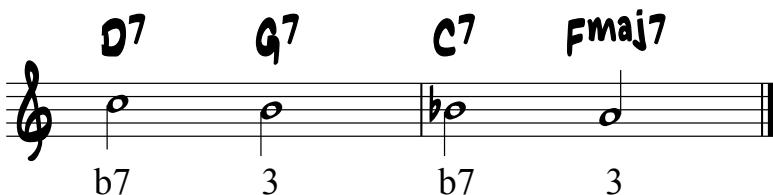
FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #161

Voice Leading is one of the biggest and best tools we have as an improviser. Every one of our heroes used it constantly, even if they didn't think about this technical term for it. Either way, they "heard it," and they certainly understood it's importance and value.

Voice Leading (Guide Tones is another similar term) is how we connect the notes of one chord to another. Look inside a great jazz solo, and you will find this constantly. The classic Voice Leading lines use 3rds and 7ths, but we find Voice Leading lines that use 9ths, or #11's, #5's and other extensions. There are *many* possible lines over a given set of chords.

Two good rules for getting started with Voice Leading are 1) move by the smallest distance/interval possible (half steps are best), and 2) stay on the same note if you can.

#1 - Prelude To A Kiss, 3rds & 7ths



One of the "classic" Voice Leading lines for ANY song, using just 3rds and 7ths, moving by 1/2 step.

WAYS TO PRACTICE VOICE LEADING

- 1) Play the Voice Leading line. A lot. Get it in your ears.
- 2) Embellish only ABOVE the Voice Leading line with chord tones.
- 3) Embellish only ABOVE the Voice Leading line with diatonic or chromatic neighbors
- 4) Embellish only BELOW the Voice Leading line with chord tones.
- 5) Embellish only BELOW the Voice Leading line with diatonic or chromatic neighbors

#2 - Prelude To A Kiss solo, usng 3rds & 7ths

